

M1.1 Conspiracies Everywhere

Boyce, Jacob
Social Studies_7-9

Conspiracies Everywhere

In this lesson we cover the classroom rules and norms. The course expectations and assessments. We will look at the wide range of events that can be considered a conspiracy and then conduct research on a single one.

Essential Question:
What are the limitations we have when deciding whether to believe in conspiracies?

Objectives:
~ describe classroom rules
~ describe pretest/post test procedures
~ describe the breadth of conspiracies.
~ seek precise information with keywords and filtering
~ modify a basic script
~ use basic recording equipment

Module1.1 Class 1
Agenda 1120-1215,1255-1355+:
1120-1130: Classroom Rules/procedures
1130-1140: Conspiracy Game Warm up
1140-1155: Definitions
1155-1205: Pretest
1205-1215 Brainstorming concepts lecture
Lunch
1255-1310 Brainstorming Technique 1: Rapid Ideation
1310-1340 First Recording Research and Script*
1340-1355 Post Scripting Discussion Questions

Module1.1 Class 2
Agenda 1120-1215,1255-1355+:
1120-1215: First Recording*
Lunch
1255-1305 Conspiracy Theory Game
1305-1325 Post Recording Discussion Questions
1340-1355 Decision Making Part 1

Standards:
CC. 8.1.8.B Compare and contrast a historical event, using multiple points of view from primary and secondary sources.
CC.8.5.9-10.D: Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in a text, including vocabulary describing political, social, or economic

aspects of history/social science.
8.4.9.A: Analyze the significance of individuals and groups who have shaped the development of world history.
CC.1.5.8.A: Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions (one-on-one, in groups, and teacher-led) with diverse partners on grade-level topics, texts, and issues, building on others' ideas and expressing their own clearly.

Pre-Test: What are the limitations we have when deciding whether to believe in conspiracies?

What is a Conspiracy Theory

Definitions

conspiracy

conspiracy noun con·spir·a·cy

Brainstorming Technique 1: Rapid Ideation

Concepts (lecture):
Divergent thinking
synergy

1: the act of conspiring together
2: an agreement among conspirators

conspire

1: to join in a secret agreement to do an unlawful or wrongful act or an act which becomes unlawful as a result of the secret agreement
2: to act in harmony toward a common end
Circumstances *conspired* to defeat his efforts.

theory

A scheme or system of ideas or statements held as an explanation or account of a group of facts or phenomena. (An explanation of why something behaves the way it does.)

law

A set of observed regularities expressed in a concise verbal or mathematical statement. (A reliable and repeatable observation of somethings behavior)

priming

Goal:
In groups of 3-4, set a timer for 8 minutes, and come up with as many unique conspiracy theories as you can think of. Stretch your thinking beyond traditional conspiracy theories and consider anything that would fit the definitions.

Criteria	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
Communication	Exceptional communication: Ideas are clearly and effectively shared, with active listening and building on each other's ideas. All group members participate fully.	Exceptional communication: Ideas are clearly shared, with many examples provided. Most group members actively participate and engage.	Adequate attempt at communication: Some ideas are shared, but communication may be limited or unclear. Participation is inconsistent.	Low effort or communication: Few ideas are shared, or communication is minimal. Participation is limited to one or two group members.
Use of Divergent Thinking	Exceptional use of divergent thinking: A wide variety of creative, innovative, and unique ideas are generated, showing deep exploration of possibilities.	Many examples of divergent thinking: A good range of ideas is generated, with some creativity and exploration of different possibilities.	Limited use of divergent thinking: A few ideas are generated, but they may be predictable or lack creativity.	Minimal use of divergent thinking: Very few ideas are generated, and they show little to no creativity or exploration of possibilities.
Group Collaboration	Exceptional collaboration: Group works seamlessly together, with mutual respect and encouragement. Ideas are built upon and refined through collaboration.	Strong collaboration: Group members work well together, with some idea building and mutual support.	Adequate collaboration: Some group collaboration occurs, but it may be uneven, with little idea building.	Poor collaboration: Group work is disjointed, with minimal interaction or support among members.

Criteria	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
Idea Generation	An extensive number of ideas are generated, demonstrating a thorough exploration of the topic.	A good number of ideas are generated, showing a solid exploration of the topic.	A limited number of ideas are generated, indicating a basic exploration of the topic.	Very few ideas are generated, showing minimal effort or exploration of the topic.

First Broadcast

In this section you will complete research independently based on a selected/assigned conspiracy theory from the brainstorming sessions. Once the "Conspiracy Theory Research Worksheet" is completed, put responses into the templates, making adjustments so that your script flows well. Then you record your script using Audacity. Once your recording is complete and uploaded, it will be added to the end of my introduction.

Conspiracy Theory Research Worksheet

1. Conspiracy Theory Overview:

- **Name of the Conspiracy Theory:**
- **Brief Description of the Theory**

2. Key People or Groups Involved: Who are the main people or groups associated with this theory?

3. Main Claim or Belief: What is the central claim or belief of this conspiracy theory?

4. Origin and Popularity:

- **When did this theory originate or become popular?**

- **Where is this theory most commonly associated with or said to have taken place?**

5. Reasons and Motivations: Why do supporters believe in this theory? What motivates them?
6. Explanation of the Theory: How does the theory suggest that the conspiracy works or took place?
7. Evidence or Arguments: What evidence or arguments do supporters use to back up this theory?
8. Counterarguments or Skepticism: What do critics or skeptics say to debunk this theory?
9. Interesting Facts: What is one interesting or surprising fact you discovered during your research?
10. Summary: How would you briefly summarize this conspiracy theory?
11. Personal Reflection (Optional): What are your thoughts on this conspiracy theory? Do you find it convincing or not? Why?

Version A

Hello, this is [Your Name] presenting the conspiracy theory about [Conspiracy Theory Name]. This theory involves [Key People or Groups Involved in the Theory]. The central claim of this conspiracy theory is [Main Claim or Belief of the Theory]. This theory originated or became popular around [Time Period or Specific Date]. [Location/Place] is where this conspiracy theory is most commonly associated with or where it is said to have taken place. Supporters of this theory believe it because [Reasons or Motivations Behind the Belief in the Theory].

The theory suggests that [Explanation of How the Conspiracy Allegedly Works or Took Place]. People who support this theory often point to [Evidence or Arguments Used to Support the Theory]. However, skeptics argue [Counterarguments or Reasons Why the Theory is Debunked]. An interesting fact I found while researching this theory is [Additional Interesting or Surprising Detail]. To sum up, [Brief Summary of the Conspiracy Theory]. Whether you believe it or not, it's a fascinating example of how people try to make sense of the world around them. Thank you for listening. This has been [Your Name] presenting the conspiracy theory about [Conspiracy Theory Name].

Version B

Hi, I'm [Your Name], and today I'm discussing the conspiracy theory about [Conspiracy Theory Name]. This

theory is mainly connected to [Location/Place], where it's said to have taken place or gained popularity. It involves [Key People or Groups Involved in the Theory] and claims that [Main Claim or Belief of the Theory]. The idea first emerged around [Time Period or Specific Date], and those who believe in it argue that [Reasons or Motivations Behind the Belief in the Theory]. According to the theory, [Explanation of How the Conspiracy Allegedly Works or Took Place]. Supporters often cite [Evidence or Arguments Used to Support the Theory], but there are also many who doubt it, pointing out [Counterarguments or Reasons Why the Theory is Debunked]. One particularly interesting detail I came across is [Additional Interesting or Surprising Detail]. In conclusion, [Brief Summary of the Conspiracy Theory]. Whether you buy into it or not, it shows how people try to understand complex or mysterious events. Thanks for tuning in! This has been [Your Name] talking about the conspiracy theory surrounding [Conspiracy Theory Name].

Version C

Greetings, I'm [Your Name], here to explore the conspiracy theory about [Conspiracy Theory Name]. The theory is centered around [Key People or Groups Involved in the Theory] and became widely known during [Time Period or Specific Date]. [Location/Place] plays a significant role in this theory, as it is closely associated with the events or ideas in question. The core of this theory is the belief that [Main Claim or Belief of the Theory]. Those who support this theory argue that [Explanation of How the Conspiracy Allegedly Works or Took Place]. They are motivated by [Reasons or Motivations Behind the Belief in the Theory], which they believe provide strong evidence.

On the other hand, critics of the theory often highlight [Counterarguments or Reasons Why the Theory is Debunked], challenging the validity of the claims made by supporters. During my research, I discovered an intriguing fact: [Additional Interesting or Surprising Detail].

In summary, [Brief Summary of the Conspiracy Theory]. Regardless of where you stand, this theory is a compelling example of how people try to explain the unknown or unexpected. Thank you for listening. I'm [Your Name], and this was my take on the conspiracy theory about [Conspiracy Theory Name].

Version D

Hey there, I'm [Your Name], and today I'm diving into the conspiracy theory surrounding [Conspiracy Theory Name]. This theory is all about [Main Claim or Belief of the Theory], and it's been linked to [Key People or Groups Involved in the Theory]. It all started (or gained traction) around [Time Period or Specific Date], and it’s

mainly associated with [Location/Place]. What makes people believe this theory? Well, they think that [Explanation of How the Conspiracy Allegedly Works or Took Place]. The reasoning behind it is often tied to [Reasons or Motivations Behind the Belief in the Theory]. Supporters point to [Evidence or Arguments Used to Support the Theory] as proof, but there's plenty of skepticism too. Critics argue that [Counterarguments or Reasons Why the Theory is Debunked], which raises some serious doubts.
One cool thing I found out while looking into this is [Additional Interesting or Surprising Detail]. So, to wrap it all up, [Brief Summary of the Conspiracy Theory]. Whether you find it convincing or not, it’s definitely a curious look at how people try to make sense of the world.
Thanks for joining me! This is [Your Name], signing off with the conspiracy theory about [Conspiracy Theory Name].

Post Scripting Discussion Questions

From Lizard People Overlords to the NSA's PRISM program, what should be considered a conspiracy?

From the “popular kids” to friends planning to make someone look bad, are there conspiracies in your life?

When does skepticism become unhealthy? How can we differentiate between healthy questioning and falling into conspiracy thinking?

How does the spread of conspiracy theories impact trust in government, science, and media? What are the consequences of widespread belief in a false conspiracy?

Post Recording Discussion Questions

Why do some conspiracy theories gain more popularity than others? What role do social media and the internet play in amplifying certain conspiracies?

What role does fear play in the creation and spread of conspiracy theories? How might fear of the unknown drive people to seek out these explanations?

Can conspiracy theories ever be beneficial to society? For example, can they serve as a form of social criticism or bring attention to real issues that are otherwise ignored?

Why are some people more likely to believe in multiple conspiracy theories, even if those theories contradict each other? What does this say about human psychology?

In what ways do conspiracy theories challenge or reinforce social norms and values? Can believing in a conspiracy theory ever be seen as an act of rebellion or conformity?

Resources and extra research

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_conspiracy_theories

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_political_conspiracies
https://www.opendemocracy.net/en/transformation/five-real-conspiracies-you-need-know-about/